

HIMWAL SOCIETY



(Registration Number: UK06008122023012444)

HIMWAL (Himalayan Women, Awareness and Livelihood) Society, an Uttarakhand-based NGO founded under the Societies Registration Act 21, 1860, is dedicated to environmental conservation and the preservation of Uttarakhand's unique cultural heritage.

AIM AND OBJECTIVES OF THE NGO

By focusing on the outlined objectives, the HIMWAL SOCIETY aims to develop a comprehensive strategy to address and mitigate the various environmental challenges faced by the unique and sensitive ecosystems in Uttarakhand, a state in the northern part of India known for its rich biodiversity and natural resources, ensuring their health and resilience for generations to come:

1. **BIODIVERSITY ASSESSMENT:** To enhance the conservation of endangered and vulnerable species in the high-altitude regions of Uttarakhand through community engagement, scientific research, and sustainable practices, ensuring the long-term preservation of biodiversity and ecosystems.



2. **CLIMATE CHANGE IMPACT ANALYSIS:** To analyze the impacts of climate change on the region's ecosystems, with a particular focus on changes in water resources (especially spring water), the frequency of natural disasters, agriculture and the livelihoods of the Himalayan communities.



3. **COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT:** Engage with local communities to understand their dependence on the ecosystems, involve them in conservation efforts, and promote sustainable practices that can help mitigate environmental threats.



4. **EDUCATIONAL OUTREACH:** Raise awareness about the importance of the Himalayan ecosystems and the threats they face through educational programs, workshops, and public campaigns.



5. **PRESERVATION, DOCUMENTATION, AND PROMOTION OF THE RICH CULTURAL HERITAGE OF UTTARAKHAND:**



- **Preservation:** Protecting and maintaining the tangible and intangible cultural assets of Uttarakhand, including its folk-music, folk-dance, rituals, festivals, historical sites traditional arts, and crafts.
- **Documentation:** Systematically recording and archiving the diverse cultural expressions and practices of the region to create a comprehensive repository that can be accessed for research, education, and cultural promotion.
- **Promotion:** HIMWAL Society will actively promote Uttarakhand's cultural heritage at local, national, and international levels to enhance its visibility and appreciation. This initiative aims to foster cultural pride among the local community and attract cultural tourism.
- **Environmental Knowledge:** Numerous elements of folk culture are intimately connected to the natural environment. Traditional farming techniques, medicinal knowledge, folk festivals, dances, songs, and the ecological wisdom ingrained in these cultural practices can provide sustainable methods for living in harmony with nature.

Geographic Reach: Our research area span rural areas and urban centers across Uttarakhand. We work locally to implement our programs and initiatives, ensuring a broad and diverse impact.

CURRENT ACTIVITIES OF THE SOCIETY

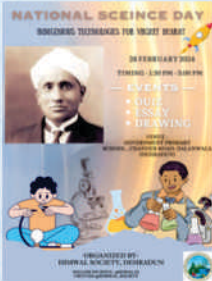
Since our establishment, we have launched the following programs:

- 1. Millet Nutrition Program:** We have named this program “**Bhojan Vikas Karyakram**” (भोजन विकास कार्यक्रम). Through this program, we aim to educate rural women about the nutritional values and benefits of consuming various crops such as millets and pulses that they cultivate. So far, we have selected villages in the Joshimath block and conducted meetings in this topic. We will take initiative to influence their food habits positively. This program will include training sessions where experts will share recipes with the women.
- 2. Traditional Seeds Collection and Preservation:** This program is named “**Beej Sanrakshshan Karyakram**” (बीज संरक्षण कार्यक्रम): We are collecting traditional seeds from various villages situated at different altitudes in Uttarakhand to conserve and preserve these valuable resources. These seeds will be distributed to the progressive farmers to ensure their sustainability.
- 3. Environment Awareness Program “Paryavaran Jagrukta Karyakram”** (पर्यावरण जागरूकता कार्यक्रम) : HIMWAL Society has organized numerous environmental programs and online webinar with school and college students to raise awareness about various environmental issues. Experts from different fields have delivered lectures and shared their experiences with the students. School students have participated in various activities such as painting, quiz, and essay writing. These programs include Celebration of National wildlife Week, World Wetlands Day, National Science Day, World Water Day, World Forestry Day, and Earth Day.

Wildlife Week Event



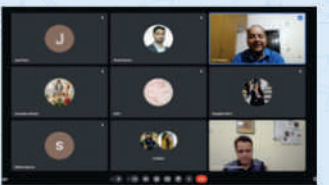
Celebration of Wetland Day at Asan Barrage in Dehradun



Event Commemorating National Science Day at Government Primary School, Dalanwala, Dehradun



Online webinar conducted during World Wildlife Day



Webinar held on the International Day of Action For Rivers



The online webinar took place on the World Water Day

4. Cultural Heritage Conservation Initiative: This initiative is titled the (लोक संस्कृति/विरासत संरक्षण कार्यक्रम). In Phase I of this initiative, we have selected the Painkhanda (Joshimath) Development Block in Chamoli district to document the rich cultural heritage of the region. Situated amidst several pilgrimage centers and serving as a border area, Painkhanda exhibits a unique and diverse cultural tapestry. Additionally, we are committed to organizing cultural programs aimed at preserving these traditions, which face significant challenges of potential disappearance.



We have collaborated with the Doon Library and Research Center to co-host an event highlighting the significance of Uttarakhand's folk instrument, the "Dhol".

CONTACT

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